Writing: An opinion essay

💡 **Big idea:** We read an **opinion essay**: "We should use less plastic to protect our oceans." An opinion essay has **four paragraphs**: introduction with the writer's opinion, two paragraphs of **reasons with examples**, and a **conclusion**.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Discuss facts about plastic in the oceans
- Identify the function of each paragraph
- Find phrasal verbs, compound nouns and cause and effect
- Write an opinion essay about plastic pollution in Oman

📖 Key words

opinion essay مقال رأي	**plastic pollution** التلوث البلاستيكي	**marine life** الحياة البحرية	**single-use** للاستخدام مرة واحدة
get tangled يعلق / يتشابك	**reusable** قابل لإعادة الاستخدام	**to sum up** خلاصة القول	**furthermore** علاوة على ذلك

Facts about plastic

- Every year we put **8 million tonnes** of plastic into the oceans
- **Hundreds of thousands** of marine animals die each year from eating or getting trapped in plastic
- By **2050** there may be more plastic in the oceans than fish

Structure of the essay

- **Paragraph 1**: explain the topic and state your opinion (However, I believe that ...)
- **Paragraph 2**: first reason with examples (One reason why ...)
- **Paragraph 3**: second reason with examples (Another reason ...)
- **Paragraph 4**: summarise and remind the reader of your opinion (To sum up, ...)

The writer's reasons

- Plastic is dangerous to **marine life** and to **humans** who eat fish
- It is easy to make **small changes**: use reusable bottles instead of plastic ones
- A million plastic bottles are sold every minute worldwide

We should use less plastic to protect our oceans. Do you agree or disagree?

Our oceans are under threat because of plastic pollution. Plastic waste, such as packaging, cups and straws is lightweight and so it often gets blown or washed into the ocean. Some people do not want to stop using plastic products because they are convenient. However, I believe that we must use less plastic to protect the oceans.

One reason why we should use less plastic is that plastic pollution is dangerous to both marine life and humans. Many marine animals die as a result of getting tangled in plastic or eating plastic. Furthermore, scientists have discovered that if you eat fish, you may be eating pieces of plastic that the fish has eaten. Therefore, it is essential to take action to address this problem.

Another reason we should use less plastic is because it is easy to do and making small changes in our daily lives will help improve this problem. For example, a million plastic bottles are sold every minute worldwide. They are used once and then thrown away. However, we could easily use reusable bottles instead and this would help reduce the amount of plastic that end up in the ocean.

To sum up, plastic waste is a serious threat to our oceans, but we can all reduce the amount of plastic we use and protect the oceans.



Model opinion essay: use less plastic

✏️ Examples

Write a topic sentence for paragraph 2

Answer: One reason why we should use less plastic is that it is dangerous to marine life.

Find a cause and effect in: "Many marine animals die as a result of getting tangled in plastic."

Answer: The cause is getting tangled in plastic, and the effect is that marine animals die.

Start the conclusion

Answer: To sum up, plastic waste is a serious threat, but we can all reduce it.

⭐ Remember

- Use linking words: One reason … / Another reason … / Furthermore … / To sum up …
- Give a real example from Oman for each reason

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ To sum up, I will now start my essay. ✓ Use To sum up only in the conclusion
- ✗ In my opinion I think ✓ In my opinion, … (or I think …)

🧩 **Activity:** Write a four-paragraph opinion essay about plastic pollution you have seen in Oman

✅ Check yourself

1. How many paragraphs?
2. Where is the opinion first stated?
3. What does paragraph 4 do?

Answers: (1) four ، (2) paragraph 1 ، (3) summarises and reminds the reader of the opinion